Guinea Pig Weekly Health Checklist

HelpingAllLittleThings.org | Print one per pig, per week

Guinea Pig's Name: _____ **Date:** _____ **Weight (grams):** _____ **Last Week's Weight:** _____

■ *Red Flag: A loss of 50–100 grams (2–3 oz) in one week requires a vet visit.*

Weekly Head-to-Toe Health Check

☐ **Eyes**
Clear, bright, no discharge. Milky white fluid is normal grooming fluid.

☐ **Eyes — Red Flag**
■ *Cloudiness, redness, swelling, colored discharge, or squinting.*

☐ **Nose**
Clean and dry.

☐ **Nose — Red Flag**
■ *Any crustiness, discharge, or runny nose.*

☐ **Teeth (Incisors)**
Whitish, properly aligned, not overgrown. Check by gently pulling back lips.

☐ **Teeth — Red Flag**
■ *Broken, misaligned, or overgrown teeth. Drooling may indicate molar problems.*

☐ **Skin & Coat**
Skin clean, no flakes, sores, or redness. Coat full and healthy.

☐ **Skin — Red Flag**
■ *Dandruff, bald patches, excessive scratching, or visible mites/lice.*

☐ **Feet (Bottoms)**
Smooth, no redness, swelling, or scabs.

☐ **Feet — Red Flag**
■ *Swelling, scabs, or raw spots = signs of bumblefoot. Vet visit needed.*

☐ **Body / Lumps**
Gently feel for lumps, bumps, or swelling. Check neck for swollen lymph nodes.

☐ **Rear End**
Clean and dry. Males: check perineal sac for impaction.

☐ **Rear End — Red Flag**
■ *Soiled, wet, or smelly rear end: possible diarrhea, urinary issue, or mobility problem.*

☐ **Behavior**
Active, curious, eating, drinking, and producing normal droppings.

☐ **Behavior — Red Flag**
■ *Lethargy, hiding, not eating, or no droppings = contact vet today.*

Routine Care Tasks

☐ **Nails trimmed (every 3–4 weeks)**
Trim just the tip; avoid the pink quick. Use styptic powder if you nick it.

☐ **Grease gland checked (males especially)**
Loosen buildup with coconut oil; wash with guinea pig-safe shampoo if needed.

- [ ] **Cage cleaned / bedding changed**
  Spot clean daily; full clean weekly.
- [ ] **Fresh hay topped up**
  Unlimited timothy hay should always be available.
- [ ] **Fresh water checked / bottle cleaned**
  Change water daily; scrub bottle weekly to prevent algae.
- [ ] **Fresh veggies given today**
  Minimum 1 cup of leafy greens per pig per day.

Call the Vet If You See Any of These

- [ ] **Loss of appetite or refusal to eat**
- [ ] **No droppings being produced**
- [ ] **Lethargy, hiding, or unusual stillness**
- [ ] **Breathing problems, wheezing, or clicking sounds**
- [ ] **Blood in the urine**
- [ ] **Significant weight loss (50g+ in one week)**
- [ ] **Any lump, swelling, or wound that appears suddenly**
- [ ] **Tilted head, loss of balance, or circling**

Notes / Observations This Week:

This checklist is provided for informational purposes only and does not replace veterinary advice. Always consult a guinea pig-savvy exotic vet for health concerns. | **HelpingAllLittleThings.org**